CB

Coverboard

Feature Guide

Every feature in the app, where it lives in the code, and the GOV.UK or other reliable source behind it.

52	225	66	7
features	code locations	legal & official sources	diagrams

1. Getting started & people
2. Leave & holiday
3. Family & statutory leave
4. Sickness, SSP & fit notes
5. Cover & shifts
6. Pay, payroll & reports
7. Compliance, privacy & security
8. Billing & integrations
9. Website & growth

Generated 02 November 2026 · staging branch

Interactive: click the contents, cross-links, code paths and references.

How to read this guide

Each feature has a card with what it does, how it works, **where it lives in the code** and the **GOV.UK or other reliable source** behind it. Everything blue is clickable: code paths open the file on GitHub (staging branch), references open the source, and feature names jump to that card. Use the bookmarks panel or the ↑ **Contents** link at the top of every page to move around.

Colour key

Getting started & people	How a team arrives in Coverboard: signing up, choosing a plan, onboarding, inviting people and managing who they are and what they can do.
Leave & holiday	Booking time off, how entitlement is worked out under UK law, and the rules that turn a date range into days, weeks or hours off.
Family & statutory leave	Maternity, paternity, adoption, shared parental, neonatal, bereavement, unpaid parental and carer's leave — and the pay that goes with them.
Sickness, SSP & fit notes	Reporting and logging sickness, Statutory Sick Pay, fit notes and absence monitoring.
Cover & shifts	The heart of the product: minimum staffing per location and shift, who could cover a gap, and asking staff to cover.
Pay, payroll & reports	Earnings history, holiday pay, the payroll export and the reports managers use to stay compliant.
Compliance, privacy & security	Right to work, audit logs, data protection (UK GDPR) and the security controls protecting the app.
Billing & integrations	Plans and payments with Stripe, plus Slack, Jira, email and analytics.
Website & growth	The public website, SEO guides and free tools, and the alerts that tell you when someone signs up.

Symbols

Plan badge	Top-right of each card: which plan the feature needs (e.g. “Growth+” = Growth, Scale and Pro).
Watch out	Amber boxes flag caveats you should know about, including calculations fixed recently.
Developer docs	Links marked this way are technical documentation (Stripe, Vercel…), not legal sources.
Not legal advice	The app implements published rules; check figures with your payroll provider before paying.

Contents

How to read this guide . . . 2

Architecture & diagrams . . . 5

System architecture . . . 5
Code map . . . 6
Data model . . . 6
Leave request lifecycle . . . 7
Sick call to covered shift . . . 7
The working week . . . 8
Scheduled jobs . . . 8
Plans & features matrix . . . 9

1. Getting started & people . . . 10

Sign-up, plans & trials . . . 10
Plan limits (people & admins) . . . 11
Onboarding . . . 11
Inviting people (set-password links) . . . 12
Team members & profiles . . . 12
Leavers & holiday owed . . . 13
Roles & permissions . . . 14
Plain-English terms . . . 14
Leave privacy (“Away”) . . . 15

2. Leave & holiday . . . 16

Leave requests & approvals . . . 16
Leave balances & entitlement . . . 17
Leave year . . . 18
The working week (one source of truth) . . . 18
Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday . . . 19
Bank holidays . . . 19
Carry-over & year-end rollover . . . 20
Team calendar . . . 20

3. Family & statutory leave . . . 22

Statutory leave types (in weeks) . . . 22
Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP . . . 22
Paternity leave & SPP . . . 23
Shared parental leave & ShPP . . . 24
Neonatal care leave & pay . . . 24
KIT & SPLIT days . . . 25
Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave . . . 25

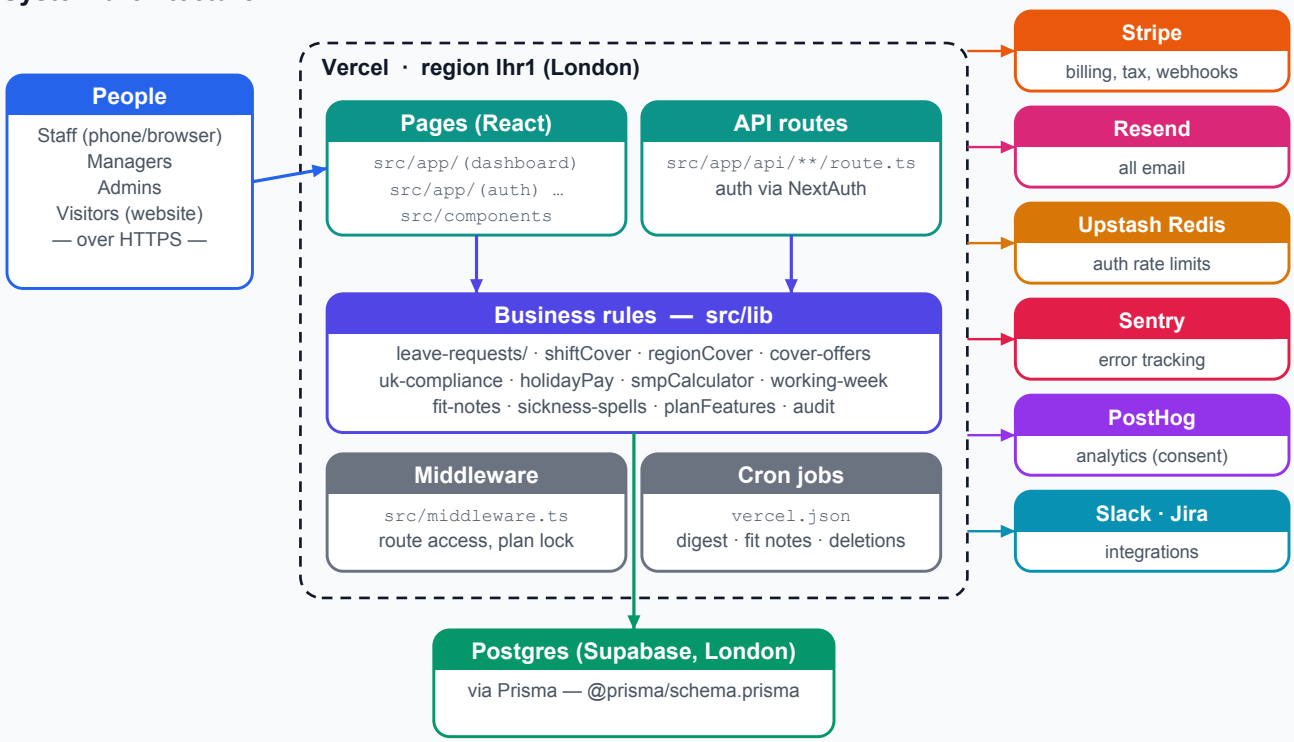
4. Sickness, SSP & fit notes . . . 26
Logging sickness (manager) . . . 26
“I'm off sick” (staff) . . . 26
Changing a sickness end date . . . 27
Statutory Sick Pay (SSP) . . . 27
Fit notes . . . 28
Bradford Factor . . . 29
Absence trends . . . 29
5. Cover & shifts . . . 30
Locations & minimum cover . . . 30
Shift types & working patterns . . . 30
The cover engine . . . 31
Cover warnings & suggestions . . . 31
Cover requests (ask, accept, decline) . . . 32
Cover in payroll, calendar & hours . . . 32
6. Pay, payroll & reports . . . 33
Earnings history & average weekly earnings . . . 33
Holiday pay (52-week average) . . . 33
Payroll export . . . 34
Compliance & operations reports . . . 34
Working time (48 hours, rest) . . . 35
7. Compliance, privacy & security . . . 36
Right to work . . . 36
Audit log & activity . . . 36
Subject access, retention & deletion . . . 37
Cookie consent & email preferences . . . 37
Security controls . . . 38
8. Billing & integrations . . . 39
Plans, billing & VAT . . . 39
Slack & Jira . . . 40
Email & product analytics . . . 41
9. Website & growth . . . 42
Website, pricing, guides & tools . . . 42
Signup alerts & founder outreach . . . 43
10. Known limitations . . . 44
11. Reference index . . . 46

CHAPTER 0

Architecture & diagrams

How Coverboard fits together: the system, the code layout, the data model and the main flows. Read these first to get your bearings.

System architecture



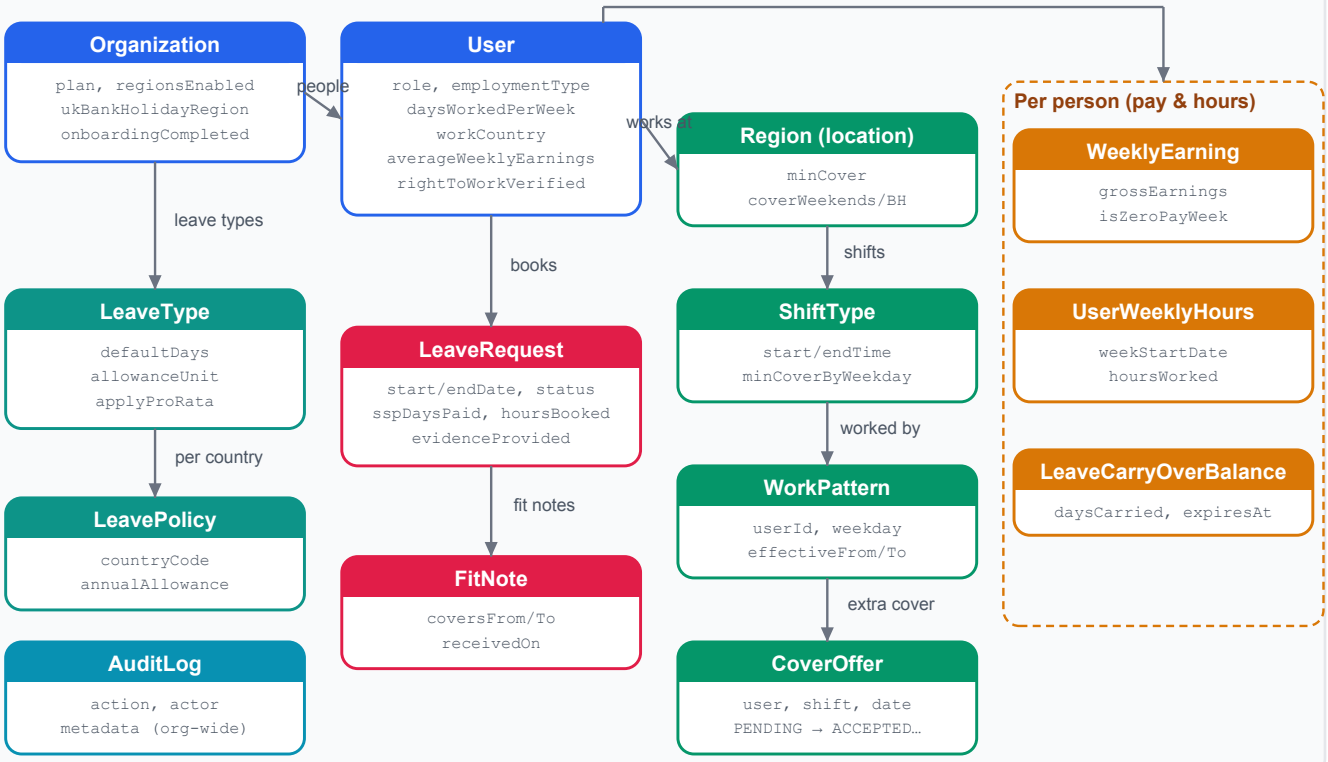
Everything a request touches: the browser talks to the Next.js app on Vercel (London), which reads and writes Postgres through Prisma and calls out to third-party services. Scheduled jobs run on Vercel Cron.

Code map — where things live

src/app	src/components	src/lib	prisma · config
(auth) sign-in, sign-up, reset	leave/ requests, cover, fit notes	leave-requests/ create, review…	prisma/schema.prisma
(dashboard) the app	dashboard/ cards & widgets	shiftCover · regionCover	prisma/migrations/
(onboarding) setup wizard	team/ members, patterns	cover-offers · cover-shifts	src/config/pricing.ts
api/ every API route	reports/ report sections	uk-compliance · holidayPay	next.config.ts (headers)
guides · tools · pricing	calendar/ · cover/ · settings/	smpCalculator · working-week	vercel.json (region, crons)
sitemap.ts · robots.ts	landing/ · layout/ · ui/	audit · planFeatures · email	marketing/ SEO guides (.md)

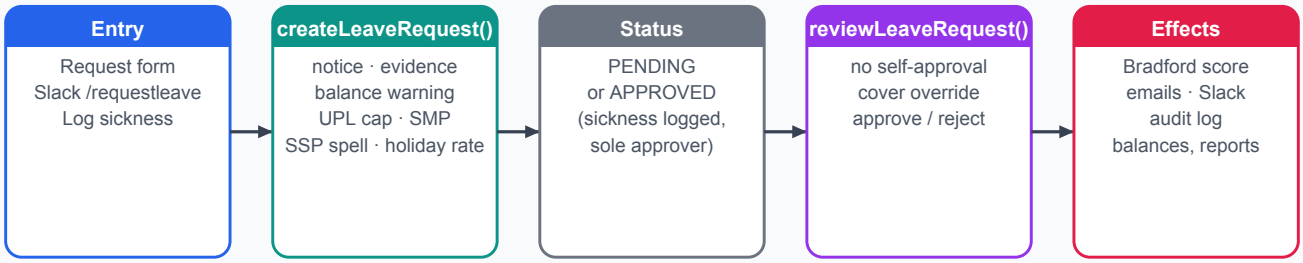
Where things live. Pages and API routes are under src/app; reusable UI under src/components; business rules (the important part) under src/lib.

Data model (main tables)



The main tables and how they relate. An Organization has users, leave types, locations and cover offers; a user has leave requests, earnings, weekly hours and a working pattern.

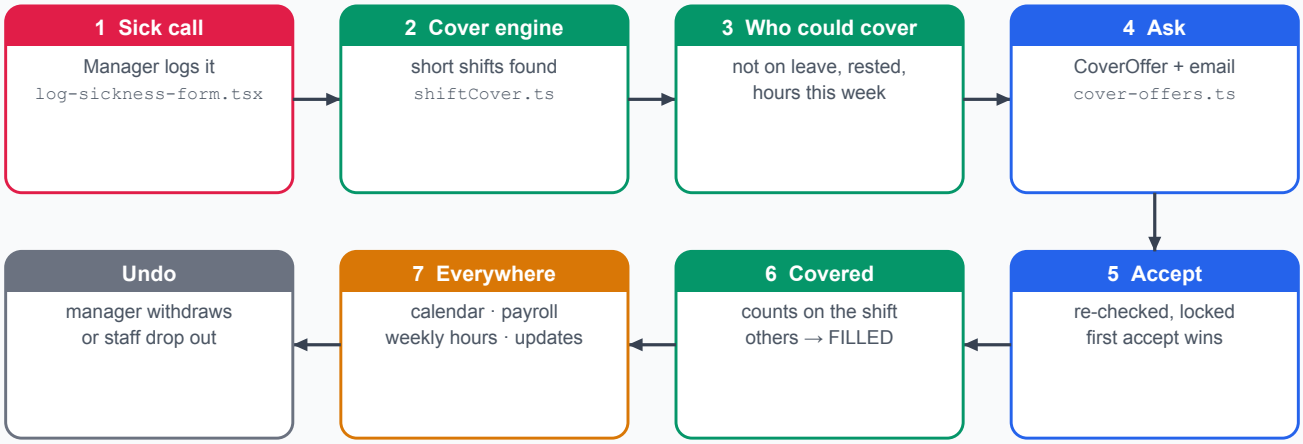
Leave request lifecycle



Files: src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts · review.ts · rules.ts · ssp-spell.ts · bradford.ts

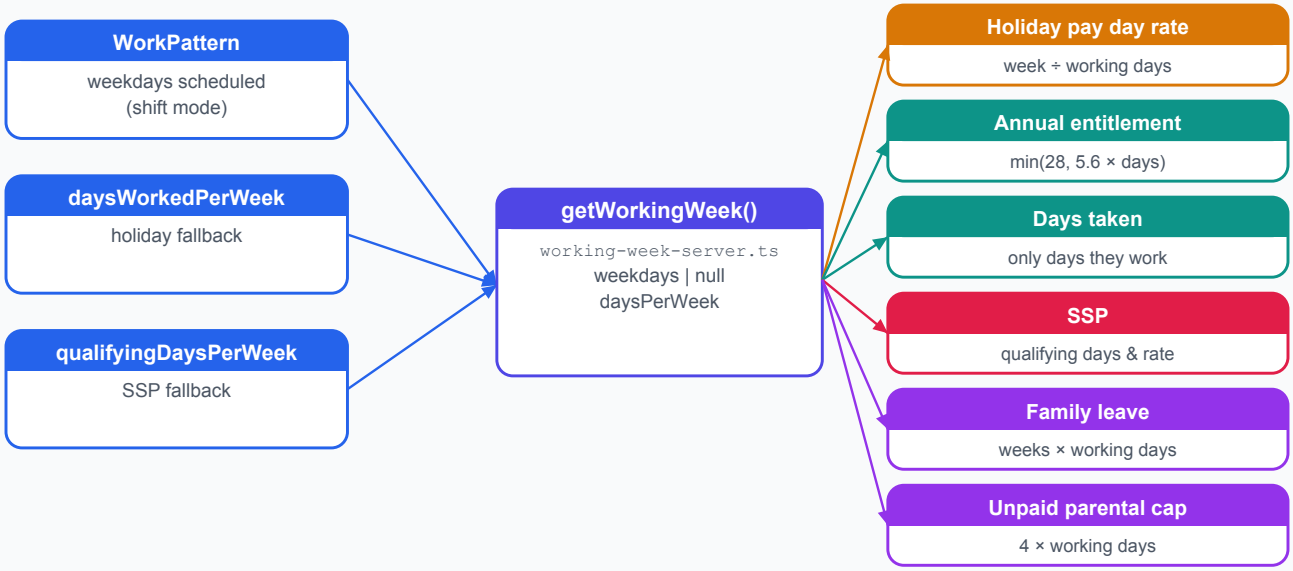
What happens when leave is booked: validation and statutory checks in createLeaveRequest(), then approval in reviewLeaveRequest(), each step recalculating derived numbers and recording an audit entry.

From a 7:10am sick call to a covered shift



The core story: a sick call becomes a recorded absence, the cover engine finds the gap and candidates, the manager asks, staff accept, and the shift is covered everywhere it matters.

The working week feeds every pay & entitlement calculation



The single source of truth added on 4 Oct 2026: one answer to “which days does this person work?” feeds every pay and entitlement calculation.

Scheduled jobs (vercel.json, times in UTC)

Weekly digest	**Mondays 08:00**	`/api/cron/weekly-digest`
Who's off this week, to everyone opted in		
Fit-note alerts	**Mondays 09:00**	`/api/cron/fit-note-alerts`
Overdue fit notes to admins/managers (Growth+)		
Process deletions	**Daily 02:00**	`/api/cron/process-deletions`
Deletes accounts past their 30-day grace		
Monthly compliance	**1st of month 09:00**	`/api/cron/monthly-compliance-report`
Compliance snapshot email (Scale+)		

Background jobs scheduled in vercel.json.

Plans & features

Feature flags from `src/lib/planFeatures.ts`. Trials get everything; a locked account gets nothing. Cover (locations, shifts, suggestions and cover requests) is on every plan.

Feature	Free	Starter	Growth	Scale	Pro
Annual leave, requests, calendar, emails	Included	Included	Included	Included	Included
Pro-rata, carry-over rules, bank holiday config	—	Included	Included	Included	Included
SSP, parental tracker, KIT/SPLIT, right to work	—	—	Included	Included	Included
Bradford, holiday pay, earnings history	—	—	Included	Included	Included
Absence analytics, compliance reports, custom types	—	—	—	Included	Included
Priority support	—	—	—	Included	Included
Audit log viewer & exports	—	—	—	—	Included

Prices: Free £0 (up to 5 employees), Starter £19/mo (up to 15), Growth £49/mo, Scale £99/mo, Pro £179/mo — see `src/config/pricing.ts`.

CHAPTER 1

Getting started & people

How a team arrives in Coverboard: signing up, choosing a plan, onboarding, inviting people and managing who they are and what they can do.

In this chapter: Sign-up, plans & trials · Plan limits (people & admins) · Onboarding · Inviting people (set-password links) · Team members & profiles · Leavers & holiday owed · Roles & permissions · Plain-English terms · Leave privacy (“Away”)

Sign-up, plans & trials

All plans

A new team signs up with email and password or Google, picks a plan, and gets an organisation with themselves as admin. Paid plans start a 14-day trial; Free has no trial.

HOW IT WORKS

- Plain /signup and every “Start free” button default to the Free plan; pricing cards pass ?plan= for paid tiers.
- Google sign-up carries the chosen plan through to /welcome, where the team is created.
- provisionTeam() creates the organisation, the admin user and (for paid plans) the Stripe customer and trialing subscription. Stripe failures never block sign-up.
- Every sign-up path runs through provisionTeam(), which also emails you a signup alert.
- Signing in doesn't wait for email verification, so a trial starts straight away; the banner says verifying is needed to invite people. Someone who really owns an address used by another sign-up can take the account over with Forgot password.
- Emails are stored in lower case wherever they come in, so Jo@Care.co.uk and jo@care.co.uk are one account.
- Changing or resetting a password signs out every other session (User.sessionVersion); the device that changed it stays signed in.
- Reset, invite and verification links are stored only as SHA-256 hashes.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/(auth)/signup/page.tsx`	Sign-up form and plan picker
`src/app/welcome/page.tsx`	Google sign-up completion
`src/app/api/auth/signup/route.ts`	Email/password sign-up API
`src/app/api/auth/complete-signup/route.ts`	Google sign-up API
`src/lib/provision-team.ts`	provisionTeam(): org, admin, Stripe
`src/lib/trial.ts`	Trial countdown
`src/lib/email-address.ts`	normalizeEmail(), emailField()
`src/lib/auth-tokens.ts`	hashToken(), newLinkToken()

REFERENCES

› Stripe – Billing and subscriptions (developer docs)

RELATED: Plans, billing & VAT · Signup alerts & founder outreach · Onboarding

Plan limits (people & admins)

Free, Starter, Growth, Scale

Free allows 5 people and 1 admin, Starter 15 and 2, Growth 75 and 5; Scale and Pro are unlimited. People means everyone still on the team, admins included.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Checked when adding people, importing a CSV, inviting at onboarding, making someone an admin and bringing a leaver back.
- During a trial, or before a downgrade to Free, the limits are the plan being moved to, so the team can't outgrow it in the meantime.
- Moving to a plan the team doesn't fit is refused, with what to change first.
- A team bigger than the plan it pays for: admins are held at Billing until it fits. Team, Requests, My time off, Help, their profile, onboarding and email links still work; staff aren't affected.
- Admins see a banner saying why, also during a trial that has outgrown its chosen plan; every admin is emailed 3 days before the trial ends and when the team starts paying.
- Scale is capped at 200 people (from 21 Oct 2026); Pro is the only plan with no limit. The same checks apply as for the other caps: adding people, CSV import, onboarding invites, bringing a leaver back, and admins held at Billing while the team is over the limit.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/plans.ts`	PLAN_MAX_EMPLOYEES, PLAN_DEFAULT_MAX_ADMINS
`src/lib/plan-headcount.ts`	planForLimits(), headcountOverPlanError(), overCurrentPlan()
`src/middleware.ts`	Holding admins at Billing
`src/components/layout/plan-limit-banner.tsx`	Banner

■ REFERENCES

› Stripe – Billing and subscriptions (developer docs)

RELATED: **Plans, billing & VAT** · **Roles & permissions** · **Onboarding**

Onboarding

All plans

A three-step setup: which countries the team works in, the industry, and inviting the first people. Choosing the UK switches on UK statutory leave types and bank holidays.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Runs once per team — the API refuses a second run so an old tab can't reset settings.
- Selecting GB calls enableUkStatutoryLeaveTypes() (statutory leave types + policies + bank holidays).
- Invite rows default to the first chosen country; invites without one used to be silently dropped (fixed).
- Healthcare teams are offered “cover by location” straight away.
- Invites must fit the plan's people limit (the admin counts as one); the invite step shows how many can be invited, and setup refuses more before saving anything.
- “Care home or home care” is an industry, and like healthcare is offered cover by location; the UK is selected to start with, and Continue says why it's disabled.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/(onboarding)/onboarding/page.tsx`	Onboarding wizard
`src/app/api/onboarding/complete/route.ts`	Saves the setup, creates invites
`src/lib/uk-statutory.ts`	enableUkStatutoryLeaveTypes()
`src/lib/country-policies.ts`	Leave rules per country
`src/app/api/onboarding/invite-limit/route.ts`	Invite limit for the screen

■ REFERENCES
› GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement
› GOV.UK – UK bank holidays

RELATED: Inviting people (set-password links) · Statutory leave types (in weeks) · Plan limits (people & admins)

Inviting people (set-password links)

All plans

People are added from onboarding, the Team page, or a CSV bulk import. They receive an email with a one-time “Set your password” link — never a password.

■ HOW IT WORKS
- Accounts start with a random password nobody knows (unusablePasswordHash()).
- The link reuses password-reset tokens: single use, valid 7 days, replaced by any newer link.
- Using the link also verifies their email address.
- Resend invite only sends a fresh link; it never touches an existing password.
- Only someone whose own email is verified can invite: adding someone, bulk import, resend invite and onboarding invites are refused until then, with a message pointing to the verification link. Onboarding hides the invite fields and offers to send the link again.
- Invited people aren't marked verified when added; using their set-password link (or signing in with Google) verifies them.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/invite-links.ts`	createSetPasswordLink(), unusablePasswordHash()
`src/lib/email-notifications.ts`	sendTeamInviteEmail()
`src/app/api/team-members/route.ts`	Add a member
`src/app/api/team-members/bulk-import/route.ts`	CSV bulk import
`src/app/api/team-members/[id]/resend-invite/route.ts`	Resend invite
`src/app/(auth)/reset-password/page.tsx`	“Welcome to Coverboard / Choose your password” page
`src/lib/email-verification.ts`	inviteVerificationGate()

■ REFERENCES
› ICO – Employment practices and data protection

RELATED: Team members & profiles

Team members & profiles

All plans

The Team page lists everyone with their location, contract and work country. Each profile holds contract details, start date, right-to-work checks, earnings history, working pattern, 48-hour opt-out and children (for unpaid parental leave).

■ HOW IT WORKS
- Work country (not “location”) decides which statutory rules apply.
- Days per week on the profile come from their working pattern, and the stored figure is corrected if it drifts.
- The start date drives starter proration and the 26-week service tests for family pay.
- People who leave are marked as left, not deleted (see Leavers): holiday records must be kept for 6 years.
- The dashboard's team size counts only people still here, like the Team page.
- Staff see colleagues' names, roles, departments, locations and who's off, not emails, contracts, FTE or start and leaving dates.
- The edit form explains each role, lists the UK first and, for teams with locations, links to the person's working pattern.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/app/(dashboard)/team/page.tsx	Team list
src/app/(dashboard)/team/[id]/page.tsx	Profile, leaving dialog
src/components/team/member-card.tsx	Team card (Left / Leaving badges)
src/app/api/team-members/[id]/route.ts	Profile API; marking as left
src/components/team/children.tsx	Children for unpaid parental leave
src/app/api/team-members/route.ts	Staff view of the team list

■ REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement (part-time, part-year)

RELATED: **Leavers & holiday owed** · **The working week (one source of truth)** · **Right to work** · **Earnings history & average weekly earnings**

Leavers & holiday owed

All plans

Admins set someone's last day: in the past if recorded late, or ahead while they work their notice. Their profile shows the holiday they're owed in their final pay.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- The dialog previews what the date cancels or cuts short, and warns when a past date makes them former staff straight away.
- A future date keeps them on the team until then; the nightly job marks them as left the day after.
- Leave after the last day is cancelled, leave running past it is cut short (SSP recalculated), and cover is withdrawn.
- Holiday owed: (entitlement × share of the year worked) − taken, plus carry-over still owed, valued at the 52-week average (reg. 14). Over-taken leave can only be recovered if agreed in writing.
- Leavers appear in the payroll export for the period of their last day.
- Someone marked as left is signed out on their next request, not when their session expires.
- The last admin who's staying can't be given a leaving date; make someone else an admin first.
- Leavers stop counting towards the plan's people and admin limits; bringing someone back is checked against the plan.
- Off sick past their last day: the leaving dialog says SSP stops then and form SSP1 is due within 7 days (“contract has ended” box).

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/leavers.ts	recordLeaving(), previewLeaving(), nightly step
src/lib/holiday-on-leaving.ts	(A × B) − C
src/lib/holiday-on-leaving-server.ts	Holiday owed for a leaver
src/components/team/holiday-on-leaving-card.tsx	Profile card
src/lib/admin-continuity.ts	Last-admin check

■ REFERENCES

› legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 14 (pay in lieu on leaving)
› GOV.UK – Taking holiday before leaving a job
› GOV.UK – Employer form: employee not entitled to SSP (SSP1, dated 10/26)

RELATED: **Team members & profiles** · **Payroll export** · **Subject access, retention & deletion** · **Plan limits (people & admins)**

Roles & permissions

Admin limits vary by plan

Three roles: Admin (everything, including billing and settings), Manager (approve leave, log sickness, manage cover) and Member (their own time off, cover requests).

HOW IT WORKS

- Role and plan are read from the database on every request, so a demotion or plan change takes effect at once, not when the session expires.
- Only admins change roles. A team is never left without an admin: demoting someone, or giving them a leaving date, is refused when every other admin has left or is leaving. Two admins acting at once are handled one after the other.
- Members can't open Reports or Audit (middleware redirects them); Billing is for admins only.
- You can't approve your own leave when another approver exists; a sole approver's request auto-approves and is labelled so.
- Cover suggestions and who-was-asked lists are only shown to managers and admins.
- Sickness notes are only visible to the person and admins; staff see colleagues' leave as “Away” (see Leave privacy).

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/middleware.ts`	Route protection
`src/lib/member-route-access.ts`	Pages members can't open
`src/lib/leave-requests/review.ts`	Segregation of duties on approval
`src/lib/plans.ts`	Admin seats per plan
`src/lib/auth.ts`	Role, plan and sign-out read on every request
`src/lib/admin-continuity.ts`	lastAdminError(): never leave the team without an admin

REFERENCES

› ICO – Employment practices and data protection
› NextAuth.js documentation (developer docs)

RELATED: Audit log & activity · Leave privacy (“Away”) · Plan limits (people & admins)

Plain-English terms

All plans

A “?” next to SSP, SMP, SPL, ShPP, KIT, FTE, Bradford, SAR, cover by location, the 48-hour opt-out and right to work opens a one- or two-sentence meaning, on tap as well as hover. Help lists them all.

HOW IT WORKS

- One source for every hint, the line under a chosen leave type and the Help glossary.
- Rates aren't repeated in the glossary; they stay with the rules.
- The Help page opens with How do I… steps: for admins and managers, adding someone, approving or rejecting, booking for someone, recording sickness and setting up shifts and minimum cover; for staff, booking time off, reporting sickness, checking holiday left and seeing who's off.
- The SSP, SMP and ShPP meanings give this year's weekly rates, read from the same settings as the pay calculations, so they change with the April update.
- Contact is one line: the support email and the reply we aim for on the team's plan, with Scale's and Pro's faster replies shown to everyone else. An ended trial says so instead of showing a Trial badge.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/glossary.ts`	GLOSSARY
`src/components/ui/term-hint.tsx`	TermHint
`src/app/(dashboard)/help/page.tsx`	Help page

RELATED: Leave requests & approvals · Compliance & operations reports

Leave privacy (“Away”)

All plans

Staff see a colleague's leave as “Away”, in one neutral colour, with no type or note. Admins and managers, who approve leave, see the type; everyone sees their own.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Every type is hidden from staff, not just sickness: hiding only sickness would make “Away” mean sick.
- Applies on the dashboard and in the checks shown when booking (who else is off, cover); staff's calendar shows only their own leave.
- Slack channel posts never carry the type or note.
- Sickness notes stay with the person and admins.
- Now also on the staff calendar: colleagues show as “Away”.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/leave-privacy.ts`	leaveTypeSeenBy(), AWAY_LEAVE_TYPE
`src/app/(dashboard)/dashboard/page.tsx`	Dashboard
`src/app/api/overlap/route.ts`	Who else is off
`src/lib/regionCover.ts`	Cover checks

■ REFERENCES

› legislation.gov.uk – UK GDPR Article 5 (data minimisation)
› legislation.gov.uk – UK GDPR Article 9 (health data)
› ICO – Special category data
› ICO – Employment practices and data protection

RELATED: Roles & permissions · Slack & Jira

CHAPTER 2

Leave & holiday

Booking time off, how entitlement is worked out under UK law, and the rules that turn a date range into days, weeks or hours off.

In this chapter: Leave requests & approvals · Leave balances & entitlement · Leave year · The working week (one source of truth) · Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday · Bank holidays · Carry-over & year-end rollover · Team calendar

Leave requests & approvals

All plans

Staff request time off; managers approve or reject, or record leave for someone (approved straight away, and they're emailed). Requests check notice, balances, overlap and minimum cover.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Notice is counted in whole calendar days; sickness and manager-recorded leave need none.
- Pending requests can be withdrawn; approved leave only before it starts.
- Admins and managers can cancel someone's approved upcoming leave, after an “Are you sure?” that says the person will be emailed.
- Approving below minimum cover asks for an explicit override, recorded in the audit log.
- Family leave asks for the dates its pay depends on: due date, matching date, days in neonatal care, and whether shared parental pay is claimed.
- The leave-type list puts everyday leave first (annual, sickness, unpaid, carer's), then family leave as its own group; sickness shows as “Sickness (SSP)”.
- Family leave shows what can be taken (“up to 52 weeks”), not a balance; types with no allowance show no “days left”.
- A first request approved because the requester is the only approver says so, rather than “you'll hear back”.
- The Jira check shows nothing until it knows Jira is connected (it said “Checking project coverage…” to every team).
- Admins and managers see a count on Requests in the sidebar of requests waiting for them (not their own, not leavers').
- An empty Pending tab says “All caught up” for approvers, not “Submit your first request”.
- Approve and Reject are labelled buttons. Rejecting asks first, with an optional reason (up to 500 characters) that's stored on the request (reviewNote), emailed and sent in Slack to the employee, shown on the request and kept in the audit log.
- Every booking ends with a message: sent for approval, approved (only approver), recorded (sickness or for someone else), plus any balance warning.
- The sidebar's waiting-for-approval count updates as soon as a request is approved or rejected.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts`	createLeaveRequest(): every check and pay calculation at booking
`src/lib/leave-requests/review.ts`	Approve/reject
`src/app/api/leave-requests/[id]/route.ts`	Cancel, and dates added after booking
`src/components/leave/request-form.tsx`	Booking form
`src/components/leave/request-card.tsx`	Request cards with pay panels
`src/app/(dashboard)/requests/page.tsx`	Requests page, cancel confirmation
`src/lib/leave-type-labels.ts`	compareLeaveTypesForList(), leaveTypeListHint()
`src/app/api/leave-requests/pending-count/route.ts`	Waiting-for-approval count
`src/components/layout/sidebar.tsx`	Badge
`src/lib/leave-requests/review.ts`	reviewNote

■ REFERENCES
› GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement
› Acas – Checking holiday entitlement
› Acas – Holiday and sickness

RELATED: **Leave balances & entitlement** · **Cover warnings & suggestions** · **Audit log & activity** · **Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP**

Leave balances & entitlement

Pro-rata: Starter+

Each person's allowance, days used, pending and remaining, per leave type and leave year. UK entitlement is 5.6 weeks of their working week, capped at 28 days.

■ HOW IT WORKS
- Entitlement = 5.6 × working days per week, rounded up, capped at 28: 28 for a 5-day week, 17 for 3 days.
- Mid-year starters get the months of the leave year they start in, as GOV.UK works it out: full entitlement × months started ÷ 12 (the start month counts in full), rounded up to the next half day but never above the full year. This is the share WTR reg 13(5) gives, worked out GOV.UK's way, which never gives less.
- Days taken only count days they'd actually have worked.
- Carry-over is used first, soonest-expiring first; when it expires only the unused part lapses.
- Everything counts within the team's leave year (see Leave year).
- Checked against GOV.UK's holiday calculator (full year, starters, leavers): src/lib/govuk-calculators.test.ts.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/leave-balances.ts`	getUserLeaveBalances()
`src/lib/uk-compliance.ts`	UK entitlement rules
`src/lib/working-week.ts`	Working week, starter proration
`src/lib/carry-over.ts`	carryOverInEffect()
`src/lib/govuk-calculators.test.ts`	Cases checked against GOV.UK's calculators

■ REFERENCES
› GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement (5.6 weeks)
› GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement (part-time, part-year)
› legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 (annual leave)
› GOV.UK – Calculate your holiday entitlement (calculator)
› legislation.gov.uk – Working Time Regulations 1998
› legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 (annual leave)
› GOV.UK – Calculating holiday entitlement for workers (section 3.2, starters)
› GOV.UK – Calculate holiday entitlement

Watch out: Proration and part-time maths were fixed on 4 Oct 2026 after tester feedback — see Known limitations.

RELATED: **Leave year** · **The working week (one source of truth)** · **Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday** · **Carry-over & year-end rollover**

Leave year

All plans

Each team sets when its holiday year starts (1 January by default; 1 April is common). Allowances, starters, bank holidays, carry-over, holiday usage and the rollover all count from it.

HOW IT WORKS

- A leave year is named by the year it starts in: an April year shows as 2026/27.
- Changing it asks for confirmation, shows the old and new years and what moves, and saves month and day together.
- Carry-over expiry shows the real date, with warnings when carried days would last the whole next year or less than a month.
- Unpaid parental leave has its own per-child year, not this one.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/leave-year.ts`	Leave year rules
`src/lib/leave-year-server.ts`	The team's setting
`src/app/(dashboard)/settings/page.tsx`	Leave year card

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement (5.6 weeks)
- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 (annual leave)

RELATED: **Leave balances & entitlement** · **Carry-over & year-end rollover**

The working week (one source of truth)

All plans

Which days each person works. Holiday pay, entitlement, days taken, SSP and week-based family leave all depend on it.

HOW IT WORKS

- If they have a working pattern, their working days are the weekdays it schedules.
- Otherwise the stored days-per-week is used, with Monday–Friday assumed for counting.
- Saving a pattern updates daysWorkedPerWeek and qualifyingDaysPerWeek to match.
- Added 4 Oct 2026 — before this, many calculations assumed 5 days.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/working-week.ts`	Pure helpers (+ tests)
`src/lib/working-week-server.ts`	getWorkingWeek(), syncDaysFromPattern()
`src/app/api/team-members/[id]/work-pattern/route.ts`	Pattern save syncs day counts

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement (part-time, part-year)
- GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get (£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked)

RELATED: **Leave balances & entitlement** · **Holiday pay (52-week average)** · **Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)** · **Shift types & working patterns**

Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday

Pro-rata: Starter+

Workers without fixed hours accrue holiday at 12.07% of the hours they work, measured in hours (the post-April 2024 method).

HOW IT WORKS

- Admins log weekly hours in Reports → Weekly hours; accrual = 12.07% of hours logged this year.
- Bookings deduct hours (default: days × their average day, editable).
- Accepted cover hours are shown beside each week — not added automatically, to avoid double counting.
- Carry-over for these staff is in hours.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/uk-compliance.ts`	calculateIrregularHoursAccrual()
`src/lib/leave-balances.ts`	Hours-unit balances
`src/app/api/weekly-hours/route.ts`	Weekly hours API
`src/app/tools/irregular-hours-holiday-calculator/calculator.tsx`	Public calculator

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay
› GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement (part-time, part-year)

RELATED: Carry-over & year-end rollover · Cover in payroll, calendar & hours

Bank holidays

Region config: Starter+

Bank holidays for England & Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland are seeded and shown on the calendar; teams choose whether they count within the 28 days.

HOW IT WORKS

- The team picks its bank-holiday region in Settings.
- Starters only lose the bank holidays after they join.
- Each cover location decides whether minimum cover applies on bank holidays.
- A monthly job (1st, 03:00) adds any missing year so every team holds this year's and next year's bank and public holidays; before, teams only had the two years from when they were set up.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/uk-compliance.ts`	Easter & bank holiday calculation
`src/app/api/holidays/route.ts`	Holidays API
`src/lib/coverDays.ts`	Whether cover applies on a day
`src/lib/holiday-years.ts`	holidayYears(), topUpHolidaysForAllTeams()
`src/app/api/cron/holidays/route.ts`	Monthly holidays job

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – UK bank holidays
› GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement (5.6 weeks)

RELATED: Leave balances & entitlement

Carry-over & year-end rollover

Carry-over rules: Starter+

At the leave year end, the rollover carries leave forward for four reasons, each with its own expiry, and shows a per-person preview before it runs.

HOW IT WORKS

- After sickness: the untaken part of the 4 weeks (all untaken hours for irregular-hours staff), no more than the days off, for 18 months (reg. 13(15)).
- After family leave: all statutory leave they couldn't take, including the extra 1.6 weeks (up to 28 days), to the end of next year (reg. 13(14), 13A(7A)).
- When the employer didn't give the chance to take it, or warn it would be lost: the untaken 4 weeks, to the end of next year (reg. 13(16)–(18)). A per-person tick.
- Company carry-over: from what's left, up to the team's cap, expiring on the date set in Settings (with the actual date and warnings shown).
- Longer-lasting reasons are applied first, so nothing counts twice; re-running replaces that person's carry-over.
- Impossible expiry dates and out-of-range values are refused, not quietly adjusted; switching carry-over off keeps the limit for later.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/carry-over.ts	planYearEndCarryOver(): the four reasons
src/app/api/carry-over/process/route.ts	Preview and run
src/app/(dashboard)/reports/page.tsx	Year-end rollover screen

REFERENCES

- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 (annual leave)
- Acas – Holiday and sickness
- GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement

RELATED: Leave balances & entitlement · Leave year

Team calendar

All plans

A month view of approved absences, bank holidays, accepted cover shifts and (per location) whether minimum cover is met each day.

HOW IT WORKS

- Managers see everyone; members see their own leave and cover.
- Filter by location; green outlined chips are cover shifts.
- Weeks start on Monday. A Month/Week switch (remembered in the browser); the week view shows every absence by name.
- Loads every day on screen, including the ends of the months either side, and both years' bank holidays across New Year.
- Staff see colleagues' approved leave as “Away” in grey, and their own with its type (leave privacy); /api/leave-calendar sends only dates, names and the type as the viewer may see it.
- People also see their own requests waiting for approval, outlined and marked “(pending)”; nobody else's pending requests show.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/app/(dashboard)/calendar/page.tsx	Calendar page
src/components/calendar/month-view.tsx	Month grid
src/components/calendar/day-cell.tsx	Day cell
src/app/api/cover-shifts/route.ts	Cover shifts for the calendar
src/components/calendar/month-view.tsx	calendarRange(), Monday-first weeks
src/app/api/leave-calendar/route.ts	Calendar leave, as each viewer may see it

■ REFERENCES
› GOV.UK – UK bank holidays

RELATED: **Cover in payroll, calendar & hours**

CHAPTER 3

Family & statutory leave

Maternity, paternity, adoption, shared parental, neonatal, bereavement, unpaid parental and carer's leave — and the pay that goes with them.

In this chapter: Statutory leave types (in weeks) · Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP · Paternity leave & SPP · Shared parental leave & ShPP · Neonatal care leave & pay · KIT & SPLIT days · Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave

Statutory leave types (in weeks)

Parental tracker: Growth+

UK statutory family leave is set in weeks of the person's normal working week, then converted to days for them.

HOW IT WORKS

- Paternity 2 weeks · Bereavement 2 · Unpaid parental 4 a year per child (18 per child) · Carer's 1 · Maternity 52 · Adoption 52 · Shared parental 50 · Neonatal 12.
- LeaveType.allowanceUnit = WEEKS; balances multiply by their working days (2 weeks = 10 days on 5 days, 6 on 3).
- The parental tracker, compliance pack and return alerts read one shared list of these types, so none is missed.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/country-policies.ts`	UK rules (allowanceUnit: WEEKS)
`src/lib/uk-statutory.ts`	Creates the types per team
`prisma/schema.prisma`	LeaveType.allowanceUnit
`src/lib/leave-balances.ts`	Weeks → days per person

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Paternity pay and leave
- GOV.UK – Parental Bereavement Pay and Leave
- GOV.UK – Unpaid parental leave
- GOV.UK – Carer's leave
- GOV.UK – Maternity leave (52 weeks)

RELATED: Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP · The working week (one source of truth)

Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP

Growth+

52 weeks' leave (a day-one right). Statutory Maternity or Adoption Pay: 6 weeks at 90% of average weekly earnings, then 33 weeks at the lower of the flat rate or 90%.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Maternity: earnings from the 8 weeks up to the qualifying week (15 weeks before the due week); 26 weeks' service by then.
- Adoption: the same, from the matching week (the week they were told of the match).
- 26 weeks counts Sunday–Saturday weeks and any part of a week, so the latest start is the Saturday 25 weeks before (corrected 7 Oct; it was a week too strict).
- Recalculated whenever earnings change and when the request is viewed; the card shows the week, the rates, the last day of each phase and how many of the 8 weeks had pay.
- The due or matching date can be added on the card after booking.
- Payroll pays the days of each pay period at the weekly rate ÷ 7, split across the 90% and flat-rate weeks.
- Average weekly earnings aren't rounded (kept to 7 decimal places, as GOV.UK shows them); 90% is rounded up to the penny, for SMP, SAP, SPP, ShPP and neonatal pay alike. Checked against GOV.UK's calculator in src/lib/govuk-calculators.test.ts.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/smp-dates.ts`	Qualifying/matching week, service test, pay per period
`src/lib/smp-request.ts`	computeSmpFields(), recalculation
`src/lib/smpCalculator.ts`	Rates and average earnings
`src/components/leave/smp-summary.tsx`	Pay panels on request cards

■ REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Employers: maternity pay and leave
› GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay and leave
› GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay eligibility (matching week)
› legislation.gov.uk – SPP and SAP (General) Regs 2002, reg. 40 (adoption earnings period)
› GOV.UK – Maternity benefits: technical guidance (26 weeks into the qualifying week)
› HMRC manual – Continuous employment (statutory payments)
› GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027
› GOV.UK – Maternity, adoption and paternity calculator for employers

RELATED: **KIT & SPLIT days** · **Earnings history & average weekly earnings** · **Payroll export**

Paternity leave & SPP

Growth+

1 or 2 weeks (may be split), within 52 weeks of the birth or placement. Statutory Paternity Pay: the lower of the flat rate or 90% of average weekly earnings.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Booking asks whether it's for a birth or an adoption, then the due date or matching date.
- Earnings from the 8 weeks up to the qualifying week (or matching week), with 26 weeks' service by then; the card names the week.
- Without a date, it uses the leave start and says so; the date can be added on the card.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/smp-request.ts`	computeSpp() (shared with ShPP and neonatal pay)
`src/lib/smp-dates.ts`	parentPayDates(): which date counts
`src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts`	52-week window

■ REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Employers: paternity pay and leave
› GOV.UK – Paternity pay and leave

RELATED: **Shared parental leave & ShPP** · **Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP**

Shared parental leave & ShPP

Growth+

Up to 50 weeks shared, with Shared Parental Pay for up to 37: the lower of the flat rate or 90% of earnings, every week.

HOW IT WORKS

- Each booking says whether their notice claims pay for those weeks; unpaid blocks show as £0 in payroll.
- The pool is 39 weeks less the mother's or adopter's own SMP/SAP weeks (at least 2) when the app holds them, otherwise 37.
- Claims over the pool are refused; the card shows the weeks left and the week the pay comes from.
- The partner's eligibility is their declaration; employers don't have to check it.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/smp-dates.ts`	shppPoolWeeks(), shppClaimError()
`src/lib/smp-request.ts`	computeShpp(), shppPoolForChild()

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay: employer guide
- GOV.UK – Shared parental leave and pay: employers' technical guide
- GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay

RELATED: **Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP** · **Paternity leave & SPP** · **KIT & SPLIT days**

Neonatal care leave & pay

Growth+

One week of leave and pay for every 7 full days in neonatal care, up to 12, taken within 68 weeks of the birth. Pay: the lower of the flat rate or 90% of earnings.

HOW IT WORKS

- Booking records the first and last full days in care (employers must keep them); older bookings can add them on the card.
- Pay week: the qualifying or matching week if they'd get SMP, SPP or SAP, otherwise the week before the baby went into care. The card names it.
- Bookings beyond the weeks the time in care gives, or past 68 weeks, are refused (or flagged on older bookings).
- Shown on the parental tracker and compliance pack; payroll pays calendar days at the weekly rate ÷ 7.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/neonatalPay.ts`	Weeks from time in care, booking checks
`src/lib/smp-request.ts`	computeSncp()

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay and leave
- GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay eligibility (relevant week)
- GOV.UK – Neonatal care pay and leave

RELATED: **Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP** · **Payroll export**

KIT & SPLIT days

Growth+

“Keeping in touch” days during maternity/adoption leave and SPLIT days during shared parental leave can be recorded on the request.

HOW IT WORKS

- Managers record days used on the request (validated 0–20).

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/api/leave-requests/[id]/route.ts`	kitDaysUsed / splitDaysUsed

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Employers: maternity leave (incl. KIT days)
› GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave: employer guidance (SPLIT days)

RELATED: **Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP**

Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave

All plans

Parental bereavement leave (2 weeks), unpaid parental leave (18 weeks per child, at most 4 a year per child) and carer's leave (1 week a year).

HOW IT WORKS

- Children are recorded on the profile, with weeks taken with previous employers, a placement date if adopted, and whether they get a disability benefit.
- The 4-week limit runs in each child's own year: 12 months from when the employee became entitled, renewing each anniversary. That's the birth or placement, or their start date if later (a day-one right since 6 April 2026; before then, a year's service).
- Weeks are their working week (4 weeks = 12 days for a 3-day worker); leave must end before the child's 18th birthday.
- Leave is booked in whole weeks unless the child gets Disability Living Allowance, Personal Independence Payment or Armed Forces Independence Payment, when single days are allowed.
- Refused when the person has no working days to count weeks from; zero-hours staff aren't forced into Monday–Friday weeks.
- Changing a child's details rechecks leave already booked for them, using the working pattern each booking was made with.
- A child can't be added twice; staff can't change their children's details, and a manager can't confirm their own; changes are logged.
- The booking form says when leave for that child can be taken in days.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/unpaid-parental.ts`	Per-child limits and the child's year
`src/lib/children-server.ts`	Children and usage
`src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts`	Booking checks

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Unpaid parental leave
› legislation.gov.uk – Maternity and Parental Leave etc. Regs 1999, Sch. 2 (the 4-week year per child)
› GOV.UK – Parental Bereavement Pay and Leave
› GOV.UK – Carer's leave

RELATED: **Statutory leave types (in weeks)** · **Team members & profiles**

CHAPTER 4

Sickness, SSP & fit notes

Reporting and logging sickness, Statutory Sick Pay, fit notes and absence monitoring.

In this chapter: Logging sickness (manager) · “I'm off sick” (staff) · Changing a sickness end date · Statutory Sick Pay (SSP) · Fit notes · Bradford Factor · Absence trends

Logging sickness (manager)

All plans

The 7:10am phone call: a manager records sickness for someone in a few taps and immediately sees which shifts are short and who could cover.

HOW IT WORKS

- Only sickness types; recorded as approved straight away; no evidence needed.
- The confirmation shows the cover impact, grouped by person for long absences.
- The audit log records the manager as the actor and who it was for.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/(dashboard)/requests/log-sickness/page.tsx`	Log sickness page
`src/components/leave/log-sickness-form.tsx`	Form + cover result
`src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts`	onBehalfOfUserId path

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Taking sick leave (self-certification, fit notes)
› Acas – Absence from work

RELATED: Statutory Sick Pay (SSP) · Cover warnings & suggestions · Changing a sickness end date

“I'm off sick” (staff)

All plans

Staff report their own sickness from the dashboard or My time off: first day, when they expect to be back, an optional note. Recorded straight away; their managers are emailed to arrange cover.

HOW IT WORKS

- Uses the team's sickness type (the SSP one for UK teams); nothing to approve, no reviewer.
- Admins and managers (not the person, if they're a manager) get “X is off sick” with the dates, never the note.
- Sickness booked from the request form or Slack is recorded the same way.
- Only admins and managers can extend it; the confirmation says so, and mentions fit notes after 7 days for UK workers.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/(dashboard)/my-time-off/off-sick/page.tsx`	I'm off sick page
`src/components/leave/off-sick-form.tsx`	Form
`src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts`	selfReportedSickness

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Taking sick leave (self-certification, fit notes)

RELATED: Logging sickness (manager) · Statutory Sick Pay (SSP) · Cover warnings & suggestions

Changing a sickness end date

All plans

Off longer, or back early? Managers move the end date so it stays one absence (one Bradford spell, one SSP period).

HOW IT WORKS

- SSP, Bradford, hours and fit-note status are recalculated; later linked SSP absences too.
- Can't overlap another sickness record for the same person.
- Shows the new cover impact after saving.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/leave-requests/change-end-date.ts	changeSicknessEndDate()
src/components/leave/request-card.tsx	Change end date control

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay

RELATED: Statutory Sick Pay (SSP) · Bradford Factor · Fit notes

Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)

Starter+

From 6 April 2026: SSP is the lower of £123.25 a week or 80% of average weekly earnings, paid from the first day, for days the person normally works, for up to 28 weeks.

HOW IT WORKS

- Average weekly earnings: earnings in the 8 weeks before the absence ÷ weeks recorded.
- Payable days: their qualifying (working) days only — 6 days for a 3-day worker off two weeks.
- Absences within 56 days link into one period; the 28-week cap covers the whole linked chain.
- Before 6 April 2026 the old rules apply: Lower Earnings Limit and 3 waiting days.
- Reports show SSP days, daily rate, cost to date and cost of the whole absence.
- The 28-week alert email only goes to teams whose plan includes SSP tracking.
- Average weekly earnings aren't rounded; 80% of them is rounded up to the penny, as GOV.UK's calculator does. Checked against it in src/lib/govuk-calculators.test.ts.
- £0 earnings in the 8 weeks before (every week recorded as no pay; every week since they started for someone newer) means no SSP from 6 April 2026. Weeks not entered give the flat rate instead.
- Form SSP1: the SSP report and its CSV say when it's due, which box to tick and link the form. No SSP: within 7 days of the first day off (the manager recording it sees this, and admins and managers are emailed). SSP running out: by the start of week 23, warned from week 22 or once the absence booked runs past SSP's end.
- The 28-week email gives the day SSP actually ends, which can be before the absence does, and links the form.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/uk-compliance.ts	calculateSspEntitlement(), payable days
src/lib/leave-requests/ssp-spell.ts	computeSspForSpell(), linked chain
src/lib/sickness-spells.ts	linkedPriorChain()
src/lib/smpCalculator.ts	getAweForUser() (shared AWE)
src/app/api/reports/uk-compliance/route.ts	SSP liability report
src/app/tools/ssp-calculator/calculator.tsx	Public SSP calculator
src/lib/ssp1.ts	Form SSP1: reasons, deadlines, sspRunsOut()
src/lib/smpCalculator.ts	sspEarningsFromRows()

■ REFERENCES
- GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get (£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked)
- GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay
- GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay
- GOV.UK – Employers: SSP eligibility and form SSP1
- legislation.gov.uk – Employment Rights Act 2025
- GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027
- GOV.UK – Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
- GOV.UK – Employment Rights Bill factsheets
- GOV.UK – Calculate your employee's statutory sick pay
- GOV.UK – Employer form: employee not entitled to SSP (SSP1, dated 10/26)
- GOV.UK – SSP: eligibility and form SSP1

Watch out: SSP days already stored on production before 4 Oct 2026 used the old weekday rule and aren't recalculated automatically.

RELATED: **The working week (one source of truth)** · **Earnings history & average weekly earnings** · **Changing a sickness end date**

Fit notes

Recording: all · alerts: Starter+

The first 7 days of sickness are self-certified. From day 8 a fit note is needed; managers record its dates (no document or diagnosis is stored).

■ HOW IT WORKS
- Status per absence: self-certified / needed from (day 8) / covered.
- Several notes can chain (renewals); gaps are spotted.
- Recorded notes set the evidence flag the overdue list and Monday email read; typed notes don't count.
- Overdue: absences past day 7 without cover, still going or ended within 90 days.
- An absence is only listed as missing a fit note if it lasted more than 7 days; a short self-certified absence is never listed, however long ago it was. The dashboard, the leave operations report and the Monday email share this rule.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/fit-notes.ts`	fitNoteStatus() (+ tests)
`src/lib/leave-requests/fit-notes.ts`	Record/remove, sync evidence
`src/components/leave/fit-note-section.tsx`	Fit note panel on requests
`src/lib/fit-note-alerts.ts`	Overdue selection
`src/components/dashboard/fit-notes-due.tsx`	Fit notes due card
`src/app/api/cron/fit-note-alerts/route.ts`	Monday alert email

■ REFERENCES
- GOV.UK – Fit note guidance (collection)
- GOV.UK – Taking sick leave (self-certification, fit notes)

RELATED: **Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)**

Bradford Factor

Growth+

An absence score: spells² × days. Many short absences score higher than one long one. Used to prompt a conversation, not as an automatic trigger.

HOW IT WORKS

- Overlapping records count as one spell; days aren't double-counted.
- One shared calculation for stored scores and the report.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/sickness-spells.ts	bradfordForSickness()
src/lib/leave-requests/bradford.ts	recomputeBradfordScore()
src/app/api/reports/uk-compliance/route.ts	Bradford report

REFERENCES

› Acas – Absence from work

> **Watch out:** The Bradford Factor is an HR convention, not a legal requirement; use it fairly and consider disability and pregnancy-related absence.

RELATED: Absence trends

Absence trends

Scale+

Monthly working days of sickness per person over 12 months, to spot rising patterns early.

HOW IT WORKS

- Separate from Bradford (a single rolling number).

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/absence-trends.ts	Trend calculation
src/components/reports/absence-trends-section.tsx	Report section

REFERENCES

› Acas – Absence from work

RELATED: Bradford Factor

CHAPTER 5

Cover & shifts

The heart of the product: minimum staffing per location and shift, who could cover a gap, and asking staff to cover.

In this chapter: Locations & minimum cover · Shift types & working patterns · The cover engine · Cover warnings & suggestions · Cover requests (ask, accept, decline) · Cover in payroll, calendar & hours

Locations & minimum cover

All plans

Group people by location (a care home, a kitchen) and set the minimum number on duty — per day, or per shift once shifts are set up.

HOW IT WORKS

- Switched on in Settings → Optional features; managed in Settings → Locations.
- Each location decides whether weekends and bank holidays need cover.
- In code and the database these are still called “regions”.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/(dashboard)/settings/regions/page.tsx`	Locations settings
`src/app/api/regions/route.ts`	Locations API
`src/lib/regionCover.ts`	Daily cover and cover checks
`src/lib/coverDays.ts`	Which days cover applies

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work

RELATED: Shift types & working patterns · Cover warnings & suggestions

Shift types & working patterns

All plans

Shift types (Day 08:00–20:00, Night 20:00–08:00) with a minimum per weekday, and each person's weekly pattern of shifts.

HOW IT WORKS

- A shift belongs to the day it starts (Thursday's night runs into Friday).
- Pattern changes take effect today; history stays accurate.
- People without a pattern don't count towards shifts — the dashboard warns.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/components/settings/region-shifts-dialog.tsx`	Shift types editor
`src/components/team/work-pattern-card.tsx`	Pattern editor
`src/app/api/team-members/[id]/work-pattern/route.ts`	Save a pattern
`src/lib/workPattern.ts`	Ending old patterns

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work

RELATED: The cover engine · The working week (one source of truth)

The cover engine

All plans

The single source of truth for “is this shift covered?” — available = scheduled − on leave + accepted cover — and, for short shifts, who could cover and who can't.

HOW IT WORKS

- Candidates: not on the shift, not on leave, and 11 hours' rest either side (Working Time Regulations).
- Ruled out shows why: on leave, needs rest, or already covering a nearby shift.
- Shows contract type and hours already scheduled that week.
- Pure function, no database, heavily tested.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/shiftCover.ts	computeShiftCover() (+ tests)
src/lib/regionCover.ts	Loads data, checkRegionalCover()
src/lib/cover-grouping.ts	Group short shifts by person

REFERENCES

- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 (daily rest)
- GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work
- GOV.UK – Maximum weekly working hours
- legislation.gov.uk – Working Time Regulations 1998

RELATED: Cover warnings & suggestions · Cover requests (ask, accept, decline)

Cover warnings & suggestions

All plans

Wherever leave affects staffing — booking, approving, logging sickness, changing dates — Coverboard shows which shifts would be short and who could cover.

HOW IT WORKS

- One short shift: a simple list. Several: grouped by person with “Ask for all”.
- The request card's cover badge only says OK when shifts really are covered.
- Dashboard “Cover today” widget per location.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/components/leave/regional-cover-warning.tsx	Warning block
src/components/leave/cover-options.tsx	One shift: candidates + Ask
src/components/leave/cover-by-person.tsx	Grouped view
src/components/leave/regional-cover-panel.tsx	Panel on request cards
src/components/dashboard/region-cover-widget.tsx	Dashboard widget
src/app/api/cover-check/route.ts	Cover check API

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work

RELATED: The cover engine · Cover requests (ask, accept, decline)

Cover requests (ask, accept, decline)

All plans

Managers ask people to cover a short shift; they accept or decline in the app. Accepting puts them on the shift and closes the gap.

HOW IT WORKS

- Re-checked when asked and when accepted (still short, not on leave, rested).
- First to accept takes it (a database lock stops two people filling one gap); other asks close as filled.
- Either side can pull out later (manager withdraws / person drops out), with emails both ways.
- Managers see a “Cover updates” card; staff see a count in the sidebar.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/cover-offers.ts`	Create, respond, withdraw, drop out
`src/app/api/cover-offers/route.ts`	Ask / list (+ batch)
`src/app/(dashboard)/cover-requests/page.tsx`	Staff page
`src/components/cover/cover-requests-list.tsx`	Accept / decline / drop out
`src/components/dashboard/cover-updates-list.tsx`	Manager updates card
`prisma/schema.prisma`	CoverOffer model

REFERENCES

› legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 (daily rest)
› GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work

RELATED: **Cover in payroll, calendar & hours** · **The cover engine**

Cover in payroll, calendar & hours

All plans

Accepted cover is extra paid work: it appears in the payroll export, on the calendar and beside weekly hours.

HOW IT WORKS

- One loader for all three so they agree.
- Cover hours are shown beside logged weekly hours, never added automatically.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/cover-shifts.ts`	loadAcceptedCoverShifts(), shiftLengthHours()
`src/app/api/reports/cover-shifts/route.ts`	Cover shifts export
`src/components/reports/cover-shifts-section.tsx`	Payroll section

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay
› GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics

RELATED: **Payroll export** · **Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday** · **Team calendar**

CHAPTER 6

Pay, payroll & reports

Earnings history, holiday pay, the payroll export and the reports managers use to stay compliant.

In this chapter: Earnings history & average weekly earnings · Holiday pay (52-week average) · Payroll export · Compliance & operations reports · Working time (48 hours, rest)

Earnings history & average weekly earnings

Starter+ (holiday pay: Growth+)

Weekly gross earnings per person (entered or CSV-imported). They feed holiday pay (52 weeks) and SSP/SMP (8 weeks).

HOW IT WORKS

- Zero-pay weeks are flagged: excluded from holiday pay, included (as £0) for SSP/SMP.
- Average weekly earnings = recorded weeks in the 8 weeks before the date.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/api/team-members/[id]/earnings-history/route.ts`	Earnings API
`src/lib/earningsHistory.ts`	CSV parsing
`src/components/settings/earnings-coverage-panel.tsx`	Coverage of earnings data
`src/lib/smpCalculator.ts`	getAweForUser()

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics
- GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay
- GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027

RELATED: Holiday pay (52-week average) · Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)

Holiday pay (52-week average)

Growth+

A day's holiday pay is the average weekly pay over the last 52 paid weeks (looking back up to 104) divided by the days they work.

HOW IT WORKS

- Daily rate = average week ÷ working days (£390 ÷ 3 = £130). Fixed 4 Oct 2026; it divided by 5 before.
- Irregular-hours staff use an hourly rate (pay ÷ hours).
- The rate is captured on each annual leave booking for payroll.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/holidayPay.ts`	calculateHolidayPayRate()
`src/lib/payroll-export.ts`	Rate fields in the export

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics
- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 16 (holiday pay)
- GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay

RELATED: Earnings history & average weekly earnings · Payroll export

Payroll export

All plans

Approved leave in a pay period with holiday pay and every statutory payment for the days in that period, plus leavers' final holiday pay and a “Cover shifts worked” export, as CSV or Excel.

HOW IT WORKS

- Statutory pay is worked out for the pay period, not today: SSP, SMP or SAP (with a column saying which), SPP, ShPP and neonatal pay, each at the weekly rate ÷ 7 for calendar days.
- The screen shows working days, calendar days, rate and pay per row, and a statutory pay total split by type.
- Leavers whose last day is in the period get their own table, Excel sheet and CSV: built up, taken and holiday to pay.
- Money on screen has thousands separators; exports keep plain numbers.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/api/reports/payroll/route.ts`	Builds the report and exports
`src/lib/payroll-columns.ts`	Columns, defined once for screen and export
`src/lib/export-formats.ts`	CSV and Excel
`src/app/(dashboard)/reports/page.tsx`	Payroll screen

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics
- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 14 (pay in lieu on leaving)
- GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay

RELATED: **Cover in payroll, calendar & hours** · **Holiday pay (52-week average)** · **Leavers & holiday owed**

Compliance & operations reports

Scale+ (some Growth+)

One Reports page: operations, analytics, Bradford, absence trends, cover by location, right to work, working time, holiday usage, SSP liability, parental tracker, payroll and year-end.

HOW IT WORKS

- Holiday usage counts the team's leave year and includes bookings across its start or end.
- The parental tracker shows SMP/SAP rates (even before pay starts), ShPP, neonatal pay and weeks, KIT/SPLIT days.
- “Export compliance pack” bundles the key tables; columns are defined once for screen and export.
- Monthly compliance email for Scale+ teams; weekly digest for everyone.
- Every CSV goes through one cell function (csvCell), which puts an apostrophe before text starting with = + - or @ so spreadsheet apps show it rather than run it; numbers are left alone.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/app/(dashboard)/reports/page.tsx`	Reports page
`src/app/api/reports/uk-compliance/route.ts`	UK compliance data
`src/lib/uk-compliance-columns.ts`	Columns and the parental leave list
`src/app/api/cron/monthly-compliance-report/route.ts`	Monthly email
`src/lib/csv-export.ts`	csvCell()

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay
- GOV.UK – Check a job applicant's right to work
- Acas – Absence from work
- Vercel – Cron jobs (developer docs)

RELATED: **Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)** · **Bradford Factor** · **Right to work** · **Working time (48 hours, rest)**

Working time (48 hours, rest)

All plans (UK staff)

A working-time report: average weekly hours over 17 weeks against the 48-hour limit, weeks over 48, and rest under 11 hours between shifts, with this week and next as rostered.

HOW IT WORKS

- Hours come from logged hours, else hours on pay records, else the working pattern and accepted cover, minus leave: an estimate, not timesheets.
- New starters are averaged since they started (or their first recorded work).
- 48-hour opt-outs are recorded on profiles; over the average without one is flagged.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/working-time.ts`	summariseWorkingTime()
`src/components/reports/working-time-section.tsx`	Report section

REFERENCES

- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 4 (48-hour average)
- GOV.UK – Maximum weekly working hours
- legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 (daily rest)
- GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work

RELATED: Compliance & operations reports · Shift types & working patterns

CHAPTER 7

Compliance, privacy & security

Right to work, audit logs, data protection (UK GDPR) and the security controls protecting the app.

In this chapter: Right to work · Audit log & activity · Subject access, retention & deletion · Cookie consent & email preferences · Security controls

Right to work

Growth+

Record each right-to-work check with its date, method, document and any expiry. Expired permission and rechecks due within 60 days are flagged everywhere, including the Monday email.

HOW IT WORKS

- Checks are kept as a history; the latest sets the person's status.
- Time-limited permission must be checked again before it ends.
- Checks are removed 2 years after someone leaves.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/components/team/right-to-work-card.tsx`	Profile card
`src/lib/right-to-work.ts`	Status rules
`src/app/api/team-members/[id]/right-to-work/route.ts`	Recording checks

REFERENCES

› GOV.UK – Check a job applicant's right to work

RELATED: Compliance & operations reports · Leavers & holiday owed

Audit log & activity

Viewer & exports: Pro

Every important action — approvals, overrides, sickness logged, fit notes, cover requests, settings — is recorded with who, what and when.

HOW IT WORKS

- Pro teams also log sensitive reads (who viewed a sickness note or profile).
- Actions are a fixed list so filters stay consistent.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/audit.ts`	recordAudit(), AUDIT_ACTIONS
`src/app/(dashboard)/audit/page.tsx`	Audit page
`src/components/team/activity-log.tsx`	Per-person activity

REFERENCES

› ICO – Employment practices and data protection

RELATED: Roles & permissions

Subject access, retention & deletion

All plans

Export everything held on a person (UK GDPR Article 15), keep holiday records for 6 years, remove former staff after the legal periods, and delete a whole account with a 30-day grace period.

HOW IT WORKS

- SAR export is machine-readable JSON with secrets redacted.
- Former staff are removed 6 years after leaving (right-to-work checks after 2), by the nightly job.
- Account deletion offers a 6-year records download first, is scheduled 30 days out and processed nightly.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/sar-export.ts`	Subject access export
`src/lib/former-staff-retention.ts`	Removal after the legal periods
`src/lib/deletionScheduler.ts`	Account deletion
`src/app/api/cron/process-deletions/route.ts`	Nightly job

REFERENCES

› ICO – Right of access (subject access requests)
› ICO – Storage limitation principle
› ICO – Employment practices and data protection

RELATED: **Audit log & activity**

Cookie consent & email preferences

All plans

Only essential cookies until a visitor accepts analytics. Digest emails have one-click unsubscribe.

HOW IT WORKS

- The banner reserves space so it never hides the bottom of a page.
- Unsubscribe links are signed tokens; List-Unsubscribe headers support Gmail/Outlook one-click.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/components/cookie-banner.tsx`	Cookie banner
`src/lib/consent.ts`	Consent helpers
`src/lib/email-unsubscribe.ts`	Signed unsubscribe tokens

REFERENCES

› ICO – Cookies and similar technologies (PECR)
› RFC 8058 – One-click unsubscribe (developer docs)

RELATED: **Email & product analytics**

Security controls

All plans

Rate limiting on sign-in and password routes, strict security headers, error tracking, and functions pinned to London.

HOW IT WORKS

- Upstash Redis rate limits (fail closed in production if not configured).
- Content Security Policy, HSTS, no framing; Sentry host read from the DSN.
- Vercel functions run in lhr1 (London), next to the database.
- Pay figures and right-to-work data are left out of API responses for staff and on plans without those features; the overlap check returns names and dates, not whole leave records.
- The Content Security Policy allows Stripe's card frames and payment API, so the card form and wallets work.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/rate-limit.ts`	Rate limiting
`next.config.ts`	Security headers, CSP
`vercel.json`	Region and cron schedules
`sentry.client.config.ts`	Error tracking

REFERENCES

› ICO – Employment practices and data protection
› Vercel – Function regions (developer docs)
› Vercel – Cron jobs (developer docs)
› Upstash – Rate limiting (developer docs)
› Sentry – Next.js (developer docs)
› MDN – Content Security Policy (developer docs)

CHAPTER 8

Billing & integrations

Plans and payments with Stripe, plus Slack, Jira, email and analytics.

In this chapter: Plans, billing & VAT · Slack & Jira · Email & product analytics

Plans, billing & VAT

Five plans (Free, Starter, Growth, Scale, Pro). Stripe handles subscriptions, payment methods, trials and VAT; plan changes are self-serve.

HOW IT WORKS

- Stripe webhooks keep the plan in sync (paused or cancelled → locked; a downgrade to Free → Free at period end).
- Each Stripe event is handled once: its ID is recorded first and a repeat delivery skipped. A handler that fails isn't retried.
- The welcome email goes on a team's first payment, from a trial, from Free or reactivating a locked team, whichever Stripe event arrives first; never again after a recovered renewal.
- Billing emails go to the longest-serving admin who isn't leaving; plan-too-small warnings go to every admin who isn't leaving.
- Change plan: immediate and prorated on a paid plan; from Free through Add payment method, with no second trial; Switch to Free at the end of the paid period.
- Past due (Stripe retrying a failed payment): the paid plan applies, so a trial whose first charge fails moves to the plan it chose (a locked team stays locked until it pays), and admins see a banner to update their card. The payment-failed email goes once per failed attempt.
- A lapsed team that comes back has its 30-day grace period and any scheduled deletion cancelled; the cancellation is atomic, so its email goes once.
- A £0 invoice (a trial starting) changes nothing; npm run resync:stripe-trials repaired trials marked as paying before 11 Oct 2026.
- Feature access is checked by plan in the APIs as well as on screen (TRIAL = full access).
- Plan lists match what's gated: pro-rata for every contract type, carry-over, bank holidays by nation, all UK statutory leave types, fit notes and SAR export are on Free; statutory pay, payroll, holiday pay, right to work, Bradford and fit note alert emails on Growth; the audit and activity logs on Pro. Starter adds headcount (15) and admins (2).
- The Change plan page reads the same pricing config, so it can't drift from the pricing page.
- Starter (£19) includes SSP, the SSP report, fit-note alerts and weekly earnings records; family leave pay, holiday pay, the payroll report, Bradford and right to work are Growth and above. Pro is described as for groups that need a record of who saw what.

WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/planFeatures.ts	Features per plan
src/config/pricing.ts	Prices and plan copy
src/lib/stripe-webhook-handlers.ts	Webhook handling
src/app/api/webhooks/stripe/route.ts	Webhook endpoint
src/components/billing/tax-section.tsx	VAT numbers
src/app/api/billing/change-plan/route.ts	Change plan
src/components/layout/past-due-banner.tsx	Past-due banner
scripts/resync-stripe-trials.ts	Repair for trials marked as paying
src/app/api/billing/downgrade-to-free/route.ts	Switch to Free
src/lib/billing-emails.ts	Billing emails
src/config/pricing.ts	Plan lists (marketing and Change plan)

■ REFERENCES
› Stripe – Billing and subscriptions (developer docs)
› Stripe – Tax (developer docs)
› Stripe – Webhooks (developer docs)

RELATED: **Sign-up, plans & trials** · **Plan limits (people & admins)**

Slack & Jira

All plans

Slack: new requests posted with approve/reject buttons, DMs on decisions, and a /requestleave command. Jira: warns when someone with open tickets books leave and helps reassign them.

■ HOW IT WORKS
- Slack and web share the same create/review logic, so rules never diverge.
- Paused while the team is locked: buttons and /requestleave reply that an admin needs to choose a plan.
- People who've left can't act from Slack.
- Replies to button clicks go to Slack's response URL so the person sees them; a reply that can't be posted is logged, not an error.
- Channel posts never show the leave type or note.
- The Slack and Jira cards in Settings are shown to admins and managers only.
- Jira coverage: staff only see their own open tickets; admins and managers see anyone's on the team, plus who's free to take them (people still on the team, names only, no emails). Reassigning only goes to an active member of the same team. Booking for someone else checks their tickets, not the booker's.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/slack-notifications.ts`	Slack messages
`src/app/api/slack/commands/route.ts`	/requestleave
`src/app/api/slack/interactions/route.ts`	Approve/reject buttons
`src/lib/jira.ts`	Jira integration
`src/components/leave/coverage-warning.tsx`	Jira coverage warning
`src/lib/slack.ts`	slackLockedMessage(), response URL replies
`src/app/api/jira/coverage/route.ts`	Jira coverage
`src/app/api/jira/reassign/route.ts`	Jira reassign

■ REFERENCES
› Slack API – Slash commands and interactivity (developer docs)
› Atlassian – Jira Cloud REST API (developer docs)

RELATED: **Leave requests & approvals** · **Leave privacy (“Away”)**

Email & product analytics

All plans

Emails go through Resend (invites, approvals, cover requests, fit-note alerts). Product analytics (PostHog) only run with consent.

HOW IT WORKS

- Names in emails are HTML-escaped.
- PostHog is proxied through /ingest and gated on cookie consent.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/email.ts`	sendEmail()
`src/lib/email-templates.ts`	All email templates
`src/lib/analytics/server.ts`	Server analytics
`src/components/analytics/posthog-provider.tsx`	Client analytics

REFERENCES

› ICO – Cookies and similar technologies (PECR)
› Resend documentation (developer docs)
› PostHog documentation (developer docs)

RELATED: **Cookie consent & email preferences**

CHAPTER 9

Website & growth

The public website, SEO guides and free tools, and the alerts that tell you when someone signs up.

In this chapter: Website, pricing, guides & tools · Signup alerts & founder outreach

Website, pricing, guides & tools

Public

The marketing site tells the 7:10am sick-call story, explains pricing, and publishes SEO guides and free calculators.

HOW IT WORKS

- Guides are markdown in /marketing; only files with a title and description are published (internal notes are excluded from the sitemap).
- Free tools: SSP calculator and irregular-hours holiday calculator.
- Logged-out 404s point to the homepage and guides.
- Statutory pay is labelled “On Growth and above” on the homepage, and where a page sells it (the homepage section, the SSP calculator, the guides) the button starts a 14-day Growth trial rather than Free; “Start free” stays where the page sells cover, which is on Free.
- Each pricing card gives its email reply time (a week on Free, Starter and Growth; 3 working days on Scale; 2 on Pro) from SUPPORT_REPLY in plans.ts, which the Help page reads too. Pro lists its unlimited admins like Scale.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/components/landing/landing-page.tsx`	Homepage
`src/app/pricing/page.tsx`	Pricing page
`src/lib/guides.ts`	Guides loader
`src/app/sitemap.ts`	Sitemap
`src/app/tools/ssp-calculator/calculator.tsx`	SSP calculator
`src/components/landing/statutory-pay-trial.tsx`	Trial button and note
`src/lib/plans.ts`	SUPPORT_REPLY

REFERENCES

- GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get (£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked)
- GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay

RELATED: Signup alerts & founder outreach

Signup alerts & founder outreach

Internal

You get an email when a team signs up and again when it finishes onboarding. The first 100 verified admins also get a personal email from you.

HOW IT WORKS

- SIGNUP_ALERT_TO sets recipients (default hello@coverboard.io; “off” disables; quiet on preview deploys).
- Founder outreach is capped (FOUNDER_OUTREACH_CAP) and sent once per team.

WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/signup-alerts.ts`	Signup alerts
`src/lib/founder-outreach.ts`	Founder email

REFERENCES

› Resend documentation (developer docs)

RELATED: **Sign-up, plans & trials**

CHAPTER 10

Known limitations

What the app doesn't do yet, or does with an assumption you should know about. Keep this list honest — it's what protects you when you make compliance claims.

Calculations corrected 4–7 Oct 2026

Holiday pay, SSP, SMP and other family pay, starter proration, carry-over and the 26-week service test were corrected after tester feedback. Run npm run recalculate:ssp after deploying to refresh stored SSP and SMP.

Shared parental pay pool

The app only sees this employee's claims and their own maternity or adoption pay; the other parent's share comes off the same pool.

Overseas adoption and surrogacy

Their pay dates differ (arrival in the UK, or 15 weeks before the due date) and should be worked out by hand.

Unpaid parental leave year

Uses the default scheme's per-child year; a collective or workforce agreement that sets another year isn't supported.

Working days without a pattern

Without a working pattern only the number of days is known, so Monday–Friday is assumed when counting which days were missed.

Average earnings with gaps

Weeks with no earnings record are treated as missing, not £0, and the card says so. Record zero-pay weeks explicitly so averages are right.

Cover needs fixed weekly patterns

Shift cover assumes the same pattern each week. Teams whose rota changes weekly will see inaccurate cover until a rota feature exists.

Holiday on leaving

Covers the allowance the app knows; contract terms such as rounding up to half days are for the employer.

Plan hold can lag a page

Holding admins at Billing reads the session, refreshed after a page loads, so after Stripe moves a team onto a plan it has outgrown an admin may see one page before being held.

Pending downgrade to Free

The plan banner doesn't cover a team that won't fit Free when its downgrade takes effect; adding people past Free is refused meanwhile.

Stripe handlers aren't retried

The webhook replies OK even when a handler fails, and each event is only handled once, so a failure is logged and not redone.

Leave privacy settings

Staff never see colleagues' leave types and managers always do; there's no team or per-type setting to change this.

Not legal advice

Coverboard implements published GOV.UK and legislation.gov.uk rules, but figures should be checked by your payroll provider before payment.

CHAPTER 11

Reference index

Every source cited in this guide, with the features that rely on it. All links were checked when the guide was generated.

Legislation

legislation.gov.uk – Employment Rights Act 2025	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
legislation.gov.uk – Maternity and Parental Leave etc. Regs 1999, Sch. 2 (the 4-week year per child)	Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
legislation.gov.uk – SPP and SAP (General) Regs 2002, reg. 40 (adoption earnings period)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
legislation.gov.uk – UK GDPR Article 5 (data minimisation)	Leave privacy (“Away”)
legislation.gov.uk – UK GDPR Article 9 (health data)	Leave privacy (“Away”)
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 (daily rest)	The cover engine, Cover requests (ask, accept, decline), Working time (48 hours, rest)
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 (annual leave)	Leave balances & entitlement, Leave year, Carry-over & year-end rollover
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 14 (pay in lieu on leaving)	Leavers & holiday owed, Payroll export
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 16 (holiday pay)	Holiday pay (52-week average)
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 4 (48-hour average)	Working time (48 hours, rest)
legislation.gov.uk – Working Time Regulations 1998	Leave balances & entitlement, The cover engine

GOV.UK guidance

GOV.UK – Adoption pay and leave	—
GOV.UK – Calculate holiday entitlement	Leave balances & entitlement
GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement (part-time, part-year)	Team members & profiles, Leave balances & entitlement, The working week (one source of truth), Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday
GOV.UK – Calculate your employee's statutory sick pay	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Calculate your holiday entitlement (calculator)	Leave balances & entitlement
GOV.UK – Calculating holiday entitlement for workers (section 3.2, starters)	Leave balances & entitlement
GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay	Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday, Cover in payroll, calendar & hours, Holiday pay (52-week average), Website, pricing, guides & tools
GOV.UK – Carer's leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
GOV.UK – Check a job applicant's right to work	Compliance & operations reports, Right to work
GOV.UK – Employer form: employee not entitled to SSP (SSP1, dated 10/26)	Leavers & holiday owed, Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)

GOV.UK – Employers: SSP eligibility and form SSP1	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Earnings history & average weekly earnings, Payroll export
GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay	Changing a sickness end date, Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Compliance & operations reports
GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay and leave	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay eligibility (matching week)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Employers: maternity leave (incl. KIT days)	KIT & SPLIT days
GOV.UK – Employers: maternity pay and leave	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay and leave	Neonatal care leave & pay
GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay eligibility (relevant week)	Neonatal care leave & pay
GOV.UK – Employers: paternity pay and leave	Paternity leave & SPP
GOV.UK – Employment Rights Bill factsheets	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Fit note guidance (collection)	Fit notes
GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement	Onboarding, Leave requests & approvals, Carry-over & year-end rollover
GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement (5.6 weeks)	Leave balances & entitlement, Leave year, Bank holidays
GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics	Cover in payroll, calendar & hours, Earnings history & average weekly earnings, Holiday pay (52-week average), Payroll export
GOV.UK – Maternity benefits: technical guidance (26 weeks into the qualifying week)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Maternity leave (52 weeks)	Statutory leave types (in weeks)
GOV.UK – Maternity pay and leave	—
GOV.UK – Maternity, adoption and paternity calculator for employers	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Maximum weekly working hours	The cover engine, Working time (48 hours, rest)
GOV.UK – Neonatal care pay and leave	Neonatal care leave & pay
GOV.UK – Parental Bereavement Pay and Leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
GOV.UK – Paternity pay and leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Paternity leave & SPP
GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP, Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Earnings history & average weekly earnings
GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work	Locations & minimum cover, Shift types & working patterns, The cover engine, Cover warnings & suggestions, Cover requests (ask, accept, decline), Working time (48 hours, rest)
GOV.UK – SSP: eligibility and form SSP1	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get (£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked)	The working week (one source of truth), Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Website, pricing, guides & tools
GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay	Shared parental leave & ShPP
GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay: employer guide	Shared parental leave & ShPP
GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave: employer guidance (SPLIT days)	KIT & SPLIT days
GOV.UK – Shared parental leave and pay: employers' technical guide	Shared parental leave & ShPP
GOV.UK – Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Taking holiday before leaving a job	Leavers & holiday owed

GOV.UK – Taking sick leave (self-certification, fit notes)	Logging sickness (manager), “I'm off sick” (staff), Fit notes
GOV.UK – UK bank holidays	Onboarding, Bank holidays, Team calendar
GOV.UK – Unpaid parental leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
HMRC manual – Continuous employment (statutory payments)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP

Acas

Acas – Absence from work	Logging sickness (manager), Bradford Factor, Absence trends, Compliance & operations reports
Acas – Checking holiday entitlement	Leave requests & approvals
Acas – Holiday and sickness	Leave requests & approvals, Carry-over & year-end rollover

Information Commissioner's Office (UK GDPR)

ICO – Cookies and similar technologies (PECR)	Cookie consent & email preferences, Email & product analytics
ICO – Employment practices and data protection	Inviting people (set-password links), Roles & permissions, Leave privacy (“Away”), Audit log & activity, Subject access, retention & deletion, Security controls
ICO – Right of access (subject access requests)	Subject access, retention & deletion
ICO – Special category data	Leave privacy (“Away”)
ICO – Storage limitation principle	Subject access, retention & deletion

Developer documentation

Next.js documentation	Architecture
Prisma documentation	Architecture
NextAuth.js documentation	Roles & permissions
Stripe – Billing and subscriptions	Sign-up, plans & trials, Plan limits (people & admins), Plans, billing & VAT
Stripe – Tax	Plans, billing & VAT
Stripe – Webhooks	Plans, billing & VAT
Vercel – Function regions	Security controls
Vercel – Cron jobs	Compliance & operations reports, Security controls
Resend documentation	Email & product analytics, Signup alerts & founder outreach
Upstash – Rate limiting	Security controls
Sentry – Next.js	Security controls
PostHog documentation	Email & product analytics
Slack API – Slash commands and interactivity	Slack & Jira
Atlassian – Jira Cloud REST API	Slack & Jira
MDN – Content Security Policy	Security controls
RFC 8058 – One-click unsubscribe	Cookie consent & email preferences